MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL SECTIONS

How this course works

What the exam tests, what has changed since the guide was written, and how to use the next forty modules well.

DOMAIN All sections EXAM WEIGHT - MODULE 00 of 40

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Every option on this exam is a real feature that would half work. The marks go to whoever spots **the sentence that rules three of them out**.

This certification suits you if

- You build, or are about to build, **RAG applications and agents** on Databricks.
- You are a data engineer, ML engineer or developer moving into generative AI work.
- You can read Python comfortably. Non-ML data code may appear as SQL.
- There is **no formal prerequisite**. Databricks recommends six months hands-on.
- It is not a theory exam. Knowing how transformers work earns very little here.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> You do not need to have used every feature. You do need to know what each one is for, and what it is not for.

What exam day looks like

	DETAIL
Questions	45 scored. Unscored trial items may be added, unmarked, with extra time
Formats	Multiple choice, and multiple selection such as choose two
Time	90 minutes
Cost	200 US dollars
Delivery	Online proctored, or at a test centre. No aids allowed
Languages	English, Japanese, Brazilian Portuguese, Korean
Validity	Two years. Recertify by sitting the live exam again

ON THE EXAM

Ninety minutes for forty-five questions is two minutes each. That is generous if you read carefully the first time. Module 37 covers pacing.

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Six sections, and how they are weighted

SECTION	WEIGHT
1 - Design Applications	14%
2 - Data Preparation	14%
3 - Application Development	30%
4 - Assembling and Deploying Applications	22%
5 - Governance	8%
6 - Evaluation and Monitoring	12%

ON THE EXAM

Sections 3 and 4 together are 52% of the exam. The marker on the left edge of every slide shows which section you are in.

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The six sections are one build, in order

01
Design
Turn a business goal into tasks, prompts and tools.

02
Prepare
Choose sources, extract, chunk, store.

03
Develop
Pick models, write prompts, add guardrails, build agents.

04
Deploy
Package, index, serve, secure, version.

05
Govern
Protect inputs, data and the business.

06
Evaluate
Measure quality, then watch it live.

ON THE EXAM

When a question feels unfamiliar, ask which stage of the build it is about. That usually narrows the options by half.

The exam guide is older than the product

THE GUIDE SAYS	THE DOCS NOW SAY	SINCE
Vector Search	Databricks AI Search	June 2026
Genie Spaces	Genie Agents	July 2026
Mosaic AI Agent Framework	Agent Bricks Custom Agents	Feb 2026
Multiagent Supervisor	Supervisor Agent	2026
AI Gateway	Unity AI Gateway	2026

ON THE EXAM

This course uses the current name with the guide's name alongside it on first use. The exam may use either.

Recommended is not the same as examined

- **ResponsesAgent** is now recommended for authoring agents. ChatAgent is legacy but supported.
- New agents are recommended on **Databricks Apps**. The Model Serving route is still documented and still examined.
- Evaluation moved to MLflow 3 scorers. Older Agent Evaluation calls are the migration source.
- The **Supervisor API** reaches end of life on 30 September 2026. The Supervisor Agent does not.
- Model line-ups change monthly, so the course teaches how to choose a model, not a list.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Answer the exam from the guide's world. Build in today's. Where the two differ, the course says so on the slide.

Why this course is different

- A bank of 109 practice questions was analysed for **which decisions get tested**. None is reused.
- Every explanation is sourced from **Databricks documentation**, checked in September 2026.
- All scenarios are original. Each wrong option says **why it is wrong**.
- About a fifth of the guide is barely covered by typical banks. It gets full treatment here.
- It will not teach you to memorise answers. Recycled questions stop working when the wording changes.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Knowing why a distractor fails transfers to questions you have never seen. Knowing the right answer to one question does not.

Forty modules, in the order you build

MODULES	WHAT THEY COVER
01 - 05 Design	Tasks, formatted prompts, tools, Agent Bricks
06 - 10 Data	Sources, extraction, chunking, re-ranking, retrieval metrics
11 - 20 Develop	Models, embeddings, prompts, frameworks, guardrails, agents, Genie
21 - 28 Deploy	AI Search, packaging, serving, access, memory, MCP, CI/CD, interfaces
29 - 30 Govern	Malicious input, masking, licensing, problematic data
31 - 34 Evaluate	Judges, scorers, SME feedback, metrics, monitoring, cost
35 - 40 Finish	What changed, confusion pairs, exam technique, three practice exams

ON THE EXAM

Modules 35 to 37 add almost no new content. They turn understanding into recognition, which is where borderline passes become comfortable ones.

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Four conventions you will see throughout

- The **amber bar** at the bottom is the exam takeaway, not a summary.
- **Tiebreaker** slides put two plausible answers side by side with the rule that separates them.
- Two fictional companies recur: **Harbourline Mutual**, an insurer, and **Pennant Outdoor**, a retailer.
- Current product names appear with the guide's name alongside, on first use in each module.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> If you only have time to revise one slide type, revise the tiebreakers.

When a scenario appears, **pause and commit to an answer** before the walkthrough. Watching without answering teaches almost nothing.

How to use the course if you have a date

01

Watch in order

Later modules assume earlier vocabulary.

02

Practice exam 1

Straight after module 37. Timed.

03

Read your misses

Which section do they cluster in?

04

Rewatch that section

Only that one. Scenarios first.

05

Exams 2 and 3

Spaced a few days apart. Then 35 to 37 again.

ON THE EXAM

Revising what you already know feels productive because the scores stay high. It moves nothing. Spend the time where you miss.

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The exam asks one question in forty-five different ways: **given this constraint, which option fits?**

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